

**SYNTHETIC COURT DOCUMENT — FICTIONAL CASE — NOT AN
ACTUAL FILING**

Record class: appellee counsel appearance and noncorporate disclosure.

UNITED STATES COURT OF APPEALS FOR THE FOURTH CIRCUIT

No. SYN-CA4-26-CV-4104 · Ellison appearance

Mara Ellison's Appearance and Disclosure Statement

Filed January 23, 2026.

Counsel appears for appellee Mara Ellison. Ellison is the plaintiff in Western District of Virginia Civil Action No. SYN-WDVA-25-CV-0733 and will defend the district court's January 9, 2026 denial of Officer Nolan Rusk's summary-judgment motion. She is an individual and has no parent corporation, publicly traded ownership, or corporate affiliate to disclose.

The operative amended complaint asserts one Fourth Amendment excessive-force claim against Rusk in his individual capacity. Ellison does not ask this Court to reinstate the City of Alder Creek or Chief Samuel Orton, and she identifies no cross-appeal. The underlying seizure occurred on February 3, 2025; the district court has not tried the disputed physical facts or entered a final judgment.

Ellison accepts the caption as opened. She notes that the order under review contains two kinds of determinations: whether the evidence permits her version to reach a jury, and whether that version describes a violation of clearly established law. Her appearance preserves an objection to appellate jurisdiction over any effort to have this Court choose between her testimony and Rusk's conflicting account.

Electronic service and counsel contact information are recorded on the appellate docket.

Related-matter and interested-person statement

Ellison knows of no related appeal, consolidated matter, bankruptcy proceeding, or parallel case that could affect this appeal. The district action remains assigned to Judge Elaine Mercer. The January 9 order left the sole claim pending for trial or other appropriate proceedings, subject to the lawful scope of this interlocutory review.

The certified record names Iris Ellison, Officer Priya Vega, Paramedic Mateo Cole, Sergeant Lila Grant, Lieutenant Marcus Hale, Dr. Dana North, Professor Adrian Crane, and retired Captain Rowan Pike. These persons supplied fact, custody, medical, or opinion evidence below. They have no party status in this Court. Alder Creek Regional Medical Center and Alder Creek Police Department also appear as sources or institutions, not as litigants.

This list is supplied for conflicts administration and does not adopt every witness's statement. Ellison specifically disputes Rusk's asserted forearm strike and duty-belt reach. She agrees that the body-camera exports are authentic but maintains that the visual obstruction from 19:53:08 through 19:53:22 prevents the recordings from resolving the competing accounts.

Ellison will supplement this disclosure if she learns of a disclosable interest or a proceeding that should be treated as related.

Representation and service certification

Counsel certifies authorization to represent Mara Ellison, admission before the Court, and active electronic-filing registration. Counsel will receive notices through the docket and will update contact information as required. No governmental unit, association, corporation, or other entity is represented through this appearance.

This administrative filing neither expands Ellison's claim nor supplies evidence outside the district record. The appeal does not concern the validity of taking Ellison into protective custody. It concerns the force used after Rusk grasped her wrist and the legal consequences of the facts the district court was required to assume at summary judgment.

Ellison anticipates that the threshold issue will be jurisdiction over Rusk's factual arguments. She will address that issue in response to the docketing statement and merits brief as the rules permit. Her agreement that a legal qualified-immunity question can be reviewed on properly assumed facts is not agreement that the Court may infer a strike or reach from obstructed video, unattributed sounds, or disputed testimony.

Counsel served this appearance and disclosure electronically on appellant's registered counsel on January 23, 2026. Respectfully submitted by fictional counsel for appellee Mara Ellison.